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PBL 3

**FACTORS INFLUENCE UUM STUDENTS' INTENTION TO USE BUY NOW PAY
LATER (BNPL) SERVICES**

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Abstract

The rapid growth of Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services has reshaped payment practices among young consumers, particularly university students. This study investigates the factors influencing Universiti Utara Malaysia (UUM) students' intention to use BNPL services, focusing on attitude, subjective norms, perceived behavioural control, and perceived moral obligation. Addressing the limited understanding of BNPL services usage behaviour among Malaysian university students, a quantitative research design was adopted. Data were collected through a structured online questionnaire, with 155 valid undergraduate responses analysed using IBM SPSS Statistics version 29. Reliability analysis, descriptive statistics, correlation analysis, and multiple regression analysis were employed. The findings reveal that attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioural control significantly and positively influence students' intention to use BNPL services, while perceived moral obligation does not show a significant effect. Overall, BNPL services usage intention among students is driven primarily by psychological and social factors rather than demographic characteristics. This study contributes to the literature on BNPL services usage and provides practical implications for BNPL services providers, educators, and policymakers in promoting responsible BNPL services usage among university students.

Keywords: Buy now pay later (BNPL), intention to use, attitude, subjective norms, perceived behavioral control, perceived moral obligation, university students

1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

The emergence of Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services has changed the consumers' purchasing patterns, especially Generation Z and university students, who move to spend and shop online. Several e-commerce and online platforms, including Atome, Shopee, and Grab, have started offering BNPL services payment systems to attract more users. Besides, according to (Buy Now, Pay Later Users in Malaysia Audience, n.d.), shows that most users of BNPL services are young people. (Research and Markets, 2022) show the Gross Merchandise Value (GMV) for BNPL services in the Malaysia market will grow to US\$6588.3 million by 2028. In this phenomenon, the risk of rash spending by students with limited allowance increases. Even though previous studies have established Attitude, Subjective Norms, Perceived Behavioral Control, and Perceived Moral Obligation, there remains a significant research gap within the area of university students in University Utara Malaysia (UUM) in relation to these factors. It is thus the intention of this proposed investigation to examine the impact these four psychology constructs have within the intention for the use of BNPL services amongst the university's students.

1.2 Research Problem

According to (Plessis et al., 2024), Malaysia's BNPL Gross Merchandise Value is projected to rise from US\$271.8 million in 2020. This shows that the BNPL services have become popular and accepted by consumers, especially Generation Z. Despite the increasing popularity of BNPL services and the financial risks associated with their use among young

consumers, existing studies tend to examine Generation Z as a broad group without focusing specifically on university students. In particular, there is limited understanding of the psychological and ethical factors influencing BNPL services usage intention among students in UUM. This lack of focused research constitutes the central research problem of the present study.

1.3 Research Objectives

The main objective of this study is to examine how attitude influences UUM students' intention to use BNPL services. Specifically, this study aims to identify how subjective norms influence UUM students' intention to use BNPL services. Besides, the study seeks to analyze how perceived behavioral control influences UUM students' intention to use BNPL services. Furthermore, this research determines how perceived moral obligation influences UUM students' intention to use BNPL services.

1.4 Research Questions

In order to understand the factors influences UUM students' intention to use BNPL services, the research would like to define the problem such as;

- a. "How does attitude influence UUM students' intention to use BNPL services?"
- b. "How do subjective norms influence UUM students' intention to use BNPL services?"
- c. "How does perceived behavioral control influence UUM students' intention to use Buy BNPL services?"
- d. "How does perceived moral obligation influence UUM students' intention to use BNPL services?"

1.5 Significance of the Study

Theoretically, this research provides a superior framework for predicting student BNPL services intentions, builds an academic foundation for responsible marketing strategies, and strengthens the link between consumer psychology and fintech. Practically, it helps providers design effective student marketing strategies, offers insights for developing user-friendly and responsible services, and assists educators in creating financial literacy programs. Societally, the study promotes responsible spending and debt prevention, enhances financial inclusion for young people especially UUM's students, and supports the government in creating protective regulations for young BNPL services users.

1.6 Scope and Limitations

This research focuses on undergraduate students of UUM and examines their intention to use BNPL services. The research data are collected using a quantitative approach through a structured questionnaire administered to UUM students. However, the boundaries of this research should be acknowledged. The findings are limited to undergraduate students in UUM and may not be generalisable to students from other universities, working adults, or other consumer groups. Geographically, the study is confined to University Utara Malaysia and does not reflect BNPL services usage behavior in other regions and countries. Furthermore, the survey data may be subject to response bias, as participants' answers depend on their personal perceptions and honesty.

2.0 LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Literature Empirical Review

The rapid expansion of financial technology has introduced Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services as a dominant credit alternative among younger consumers. According to (Osman et al., 2024), BNPL services are particularly appealing to Generation Z because they allow for immediate gratification without the stringent requirements of traditional credit cards. In the Malaysian context, the adoption of BNPL services is driven by a digital-first lifestyle where students prioritize flexibility in managing short-term finances. This trend is consistent with global shifts where BNPL services are viewed as a convenient tool for "installment-based" consumption, particularly for those with limited access to traditional banking products.

2.2 Conceptual Framework

2.2.1 Attitude

Attitude refers to the degree to which a person has a favorable or unfavorable evaluation of the behavior in question. In the study by (Osman et al., 2024), attitude was found to be a significant determinant of BNPL services intention. Students with a positive perception of BNPL services viewing it as a "smart" or "convenient" financial tool—are more likely to adopt the service. Additionally, research indicates that younger consumers and tech-savvy proactive individuals are more likely to use BNPL services as a payment method (Schomburgk & Hoffmann, 2022).

2.2.2 Subjective Norms

Subjective norms represent the perceived social pressure to perform or not perform a behavior. (Osman et al., 2024) highlight that for Malaysian Gen Z, social influence from peers and family plays a critical role. When university students observe their social circle successfully using BNPL services for online shopping, it creates a normative pressure that increases their own intention to use the services.

2.2.3 Perceived Behavioral Control

The willingness to use BNPL services is largely influenced by perceived behavioral control, which reflects an individual's perception of the ease or difficulty of such financial options (Majid, 2021). According to (Hegawan et al., 2023) stated that consumers are more likely to use BNPL services if they perceive them as convenient, easy to use, and efficient. These features such as easy-to-use interface, clear terms and conditions, and concise communication about the BNPL services process all enhance this perception.

2.2.4 Perceived Moral Obligation

Moral obligation refers to an individual's internal sense of responsibility regarding a behavior. (Osman et al., 2024) extended the TPB model by including a moral obligation to examine

whether students feel an ethical duty to manage debts responsibly. According to (Zaman et al., 2022), moral obligation acts as an internal regulator; if a student feels a strong moral duty to act according to ethical financial principles, it will significantly influence their final decision to adopt credit-based services like BNPL services.

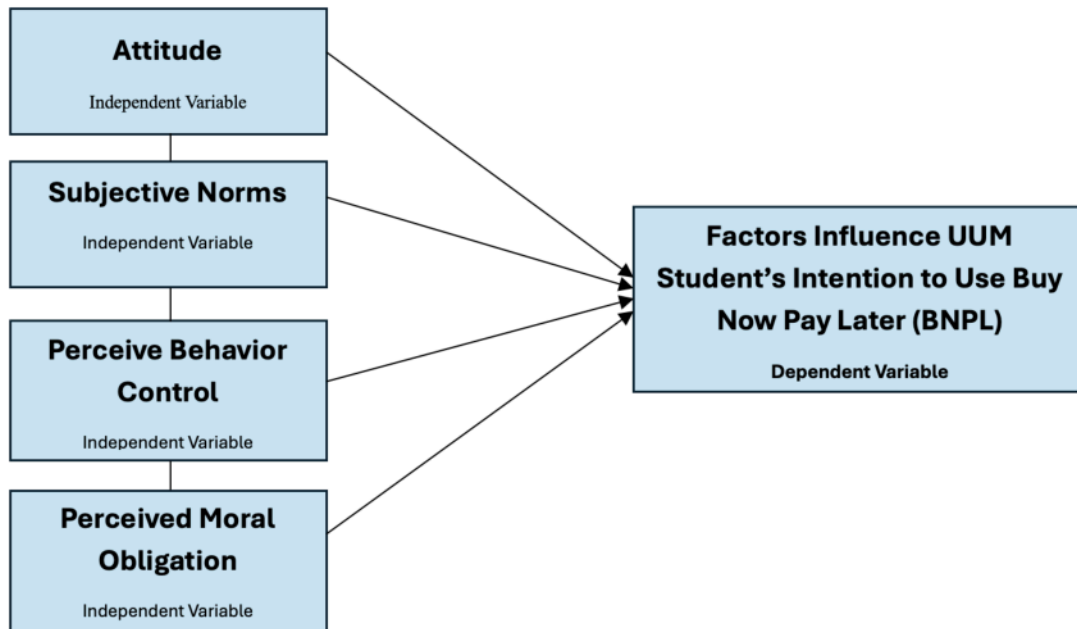


Figure 1: Research Framework

2.3 Research Gap/Hypothesis

Although existing studies, such as the research conducted by (Osman et al., 2024), have explored the determinants of BNPL services usage among Gen Z in Malaysia generally, our study focuses specifically on UUM students only. Most existing literature focuses on urban working adults or general Gen Z populations. There is limited evidence on how Perceived Moral Obligation specifically functions as an internal regulator for university students who are often dependent on educational loans such as PTPTN. This study addresses this gap by testing whether moral responsibility acts as a barrier or a driver for BNPL services adoption in a campus-specific context, providing a more localized understanding of digital credit behavior.

Based on the empirical findings of (Osman et al., 2024), the following hypotheses are proposed for this study:

H1: There is a positive relationship between Attitude and UUM students' Intention to Use BNPL services.

H2: There is a positive relationship between Subjective Norms and UUM students' Intention to Use BNPL services.

H3: There is a positive relationship between Perceived Behavioral Control and UUM students' Intention to Use BNPL services.

H4: There is a negative relationship between Perceived Moral Obligation and UUM students' Intention to Use BNPL services.

3.0 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

This study adopts a quantitative research design with a descriptive and causal approach. The descriptive aspect aims to describe the characteristics of the sample and their perceptions toward BNPL services usage. The causal aspect seeks to examine the relationships between the independent variables such as attitude, subjective norms, perceived behavioral control, perceived moral obligation and the dependent variable which is intention to use BNPL services among UUM students.

3.2 Population and Sampling

3.2.1 Target Population

The target population for this study is focused on undergraduate students enrolled at Universiti Utara Malaysia (UUM) during the first semester 2025/2026 (A251). The population is chosen because UUM students represent a relevant segment of young, digitally active consumers who are likely to encounter BNPL services in their daily financial activities.

3.2.2 Sampling Method

A stratified random sampling method will be used. The sample will be divided into strata based on faculty and study level. From each stratum, a proportional number of students will be randomly selected using a random number generator.

3.3 Data Collection Methods

3.3.1 Primary Data Collection

Primary data will be collected through a self-administered online questionnaire distributed via Google Forms. The questionnaire link was shared through UUM related students social media groups with permission.

3.3.2 Questionnaire Design

The questionnaire is divided into three sections:

Section A: Demographic Profile

Age, gender, faculty, year of study, monthly allowance/income, prior BNPL services usage.

Section B: Measurement of Constructs

All items are measured using a 5-point Likert scale

(1 = Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Neutral, 4 = Agree, 5 = Strongly Agree).

Table 1: Sample Item

Construct	No. of Items	Sample Item	Adapted Source
Attitude	4	"Using BNPL services is a good idea for payment."	(Lim et al., 2023)

Subjective Norms	4	"People who are important to me think I should use BNPL services."	(Osman et al., 2024)
Perceived Behavioral Control	4	"I am confident I can manage BNPL services payments responsibly."	(Hamid et al., 2023)
Perceived Moral Obligation	4	"I feel morally obliged to avoid unnecessary debt when using BNPL services."	(Zainuddin et al., 2023)
Intention to Use BNPL services	6	"I intend to use BNPL services in the next 6 months."	(Nguyen et al., 2022)

3.4 Data Analysis Techniques

Data were analyzed using IBM SPSS Statistics Version 29.

3.4.1 Descriptive Analysis

Frequency, percentage, mean, and standard deviation will be used to summarize demographic variables and construct scores.

3.4.2 Reliability and Validity Testing

Internal consistency: Cronbach's Alpha ($\alpha > 0.7$ acceptable)

Construct validity was assessed based on adopted scales from prior validated studies.

3.4.3 Inferential Analysis

a. Independent Samples t-test

This test will be used to compare the intention to use BNPL services between two independent groups, such as:

Gender (Male vs. Female)

As shown in the report (Table 7 and 8), an independent sample t-test revealed no significant difference in BNPL services intention between males ($M=3.1823$) and females ($M=3.5068$), $t(153)=-1.580$, $p=0.116$.

Online shopping experience (Yes vs. No)

Previous BNPL services usage (Yes vs. No)

The test will determine whether differences in intention are statistically significant at $p < 0.05$.

b. One-Way Analysis of Variance (ANOVA)

This test will be used to compare intention to use BNPL services across three or more independent groups, such as:

Age groups (e.g., 18–21, 22–25, 26+)

The report (Table 9) shows a one-way ANOVA was conducted across age groups, yielding a non-significant result ($F=0.233$, $p=0.792$).

If ANOVA results are significant ($p<0.05$), a post-hoc test (e.g., Tukey's HSD) will be conducted to identify which specific groups differ.

c. Pearson Correlation Analysis

To examine preliminary relationships between variables (e.g., Attitude, Subjective Norms, PBC, Moral Obligation, and Intention).

As shown in Table 10 of the report, all independent variables were significantly correlated with each other and with intention.

d. Multiple Regression Analysis

To test the predictive influence of independent variables on the dependent variable (Intention to Use BNPL services).

The report (Table 11) indicates that Attitude ($\beta=0.416$, $p<0.001$) and Perceived Behavioral Control ($\beta=0.417$, $p<0.001$) were significant predictors.

3.4.4 Hypothesis Testing

Each hypothesis was tested at $p < 0.05$ significance level using multiple regression analysis.

H1: Positive relationship between Attitude and Intention to Use BNPL services.

H2: Positive relationship between Subjective Norms and Intention to Use BNPL services.

H3: Positive relationship between Perceived Behavioral Control and Intention to Use BNPL services.

H4: Negative relationship between Perceived Moral Obligation and Intention to Use BNPL services.

Interpretation Criteria:

Supported if $p<0.05$ and coefficient direction matches hypothesis.

Not supported if $p\geq 0.05$ or coefficient direction contradicts hypothesis.

4.0 DATA PRESENTATION AND ANALYSIS

This chapter analyzes and discusses the findings from our distributed online questionnaire regarding the "Factors influence UUM students' intention to use buy now pay later (BNPL) services." The collected data were analyzed by using "IBM Statistical Package for Social Science (SPSS) version 29. Several statistical techniques were employed during the analysis, including reliability test, descriptive analysis, differences analysis and relationship analysis.

4.1 Reliability Test

Table 2: Reliability coefficient value

Cronbach's Alpha	Reliability
> 0.9	Excellent
0.8 - 0.89	Good
0.7 - 0.79	Acceptable
0.6 - 0.69	Questionable
< 0.5	Unacceptable

To ensure this study's reliability, a reliability test has been conducted after data collection. Cronbach's alpha coefficient was employed to assess the internal consistency and stability of each variable across all questionnaire items. Table 2 displays the standard criteria for interpreting Cronbach's alpha values and evaluating the reliability of each variable.

Table 3: Result of Reliability Test

Variable	Number of Items	Cronbach's Alpha	Result
Attitude	4	0.869	Good
Subjective Norms	4	0.907	Excellent
Perceived Behavioral Control	4	0.899	Good
Perceived Moral Obligation	4	0.726	Acceptable
Intention to Use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services	6	0.931	Excellent

The reliability test was used to measure internal consistency and a value above 0.70 indicates good reliability. As shown in Table 3, attitude recorded a Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.869, subjective norms recorded a Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.907, perceived behavioral control recorded a Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.899, perceived moral obligation recorded a Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.726, and intention to use BNPL services recorded a Cronbach's Alpha value of 0.931. All values exceeded the acceptable threshold of 0.70 and this shows the questionnaire result may be trusted.

4.2 Descriptive Analysis

4.2.1 Respondent Profile

The demographic characteristics of the 155 respondents are summarized in the figure below.

Table 4: Respondents' profile

		Frequency	Percentage %
Gender	Male	32	20.6
	Female	123	79.4
	Total	155	100
Ethnic	Malay	69	44.5
	Chinese	62	40
	India	17	11
	Siamese	6	3.9
	Others	1	0.6
	Total	155	100
Age	18 - 21	34	21.9
	22 - 25	117	75.5
	26 and above	4	2.6
	Total	155	100
Year	Year 1	15	9.7
	Year 2	31	20
	Year 3	91	58.7
	Year 4	18	11.6
	Total	155	100
Monthly Allowance	RM0 - RM500	48	31
	RM501 - RM1000	42	27.1
	RM1001 - RM1500	34	21.9
	RM1501 - RM2000	14	9
	RM2001 and above	17	11
	Total	155	100
Shop online or not	Yes	135	87.1
	No	20	12.9
	Total	155	100

The respondents' profile is presented in Table 4. In terms of gender, 123 respondents (79.4%) were female, while 32 respondents (20.6%) were male. Regarding ethnic background, the majority of respondents were Malay (44.5%), followed by Chinese (40.0%), Indian (11.0%), Siamese (3.9%), and other ethnic groups (0.6%). With respect to age, most respondents were between 22–25 years old (75.5%), followed by those aged 18–21 years (21.9%), while only 2.6% of respondents were 26 years old and above. Regarding year of study, the majority of respondents were Year 3 students (58.7%), followed by Year 2 students (20.0%), Year 4 students (11.6%), and Year 1 students (9.7%). In terms of monthly allowance, 31.0% of respondents received RM0–RM500, 27.1% received RM501–RM1,000, 21.9% received RM1,001–RM1,500, 9.0% received RM1,501–RM2,000, and 11.0% received RM2,001 and above. Finally, the results indicate that the majority of respondents shop online (87.1%), while 12.9% reported that they do not shop online.

4.2.2 Means and Standard Deviation for each variable

Descriptive analysis was performed to determine the Mean and Standard Deviation for each variable. This helps identify the general level of agreement among respondents.

Table 5: Agreement level of mean measurement

Means range	Tendency level
High	3.68 - 5.00
Moderate	2.34 - 3.67
Low	1.00 - 2.33

In this research, the tendency level of clarity was identified based on the mean and standard deviation values obtained from the answered questionnaires. The mean between 1.00-2.33 is low, 2.34-3.67 is moderate (normal), 3.68-5.00 is high.

Table 6: Descriptive analysis of each variables

Variables	Min	Max	Mean	Standard Deviation
IV Attitude	1	5	3.5645	0.9627
Subjective Norms	1	5	3.4129	1.1419
Perceived Behavioral Control	1	5	3.4968	1.0522
Perceived Moral Obligation	1	5	4.0645	0.7173
DV Intention to use Buy Now Pay Later	1	5	3.4398	1.0401

Table 6 presents the descriptive analysis of the study variables, with the minimum point is 1 and the maximum is 5. Respondents generally showed a moderate level of agreement for attitude ($M = 3.5645$, $SD = 0.9627$), subjective norms ($M = 3.4129$, $SD = 1.1419$), perceived behavioral control ($M = 3.4968$, $SD = 1.0522$), and intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services ($M = 3.4398$, $SD = 1.0401$). Meanwhile, the mean score for perceived moral obligation was 4.0645 ($SD = 0.7173$), indicating a high level of agreement among respondents.

4.3 Differences Analysis- T-test and ANOVA

4.3.1 T-test

Table 7: Group Statistics

	Gender	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error Mean
Intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services	Male	32	3.1823	1.19464	.21118
	Female	123	3.5068	.99048	.8931

Table 8: Independent Samples Test

		F	Sig.	t	df	One-sided p	Two-sided p
Intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services	Equal variances assumed	.846	.359	-1.580	153	.054	.116
	Equal variances not assumed			-1.415	42.732	.082	.164

Based on Table 7, the mean score for male ($M = 3.1823$) was lower than that for females with the result ($M = 3.5068$). An independent sample t-test shown in Table 8 was conducted to examine the difference in intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services between male and female UUM students respondents. The results indicated that there was no significant difference between the two groups, $t(153) = -1.580$, $p = 0.116$. Therefore, there is no significant difference in intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services between genders.

4.3.2 Anova

Table 9: Anova

	Sum of Squared	df	Mean Square	F	Sig
Between Groups	0.51	2	0.255	0.233	0.792
Within Groups	166.094	152	1.093		
Total	166.605	154			

A one-way ANOVA shown in Table 9 was conducted to examine differences in intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services across different age groups in UUM. The results showed that there was no significant difference among the age groups, $F = 0.233$, $p = 0.792$. This indicates that the intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services was not significantly different across age groups. No post-hoc analysis was conducted due to the non-significant result.

4.4 Relationship analysis

4.4.1 Correlation

Correlation analysis shows the strength and direction of the relationship between the independent variables and UUM students' intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services.

Table 10: Correlation Analysis

		Attitude	Subjective Norms	Perceived Behavioral Control	Perceived Moral Obligation
Attitude	Pearson Correlation	1	.672	.802	.404
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	155	155	155	155
Subjective Norms	Pearson Correlation	.672	1	.601	.303
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	155	155	155	155
Perceived Behavioral Control	Pearson Correlation	.802	.601	1	.386
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	155	155	155	155
Perceived Moral Obligation	Pearson Correlation	.404	.303	.386	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	155	155	155	155

**, Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Based on Table 10, the correlation analysis shows a positive and statistically significant relationship between all examined variables. Correlation Analysis revealed a strongest positive relationship between Attitude and Perceived Behavioral Control ($r = .802$, $p < .001$), indicating a strong positive relationship between the variables. There is a strong positive relationship between Attitude and Subjective norms ($r = 0.672$, $p < 0.001$) and Subjective Norms and Perceived Behavioral Control ($r = 0.601$, $p < 0.001$). A moderate positive relationship exists between Attitude and Perceived Moral Obligation ($r = 0.404$, $p < 0.001$). Also, there are two variables that have a weak positive relationship, Subjective Norms and Perceived Moral Obligation ($r = 0.303$, $p < 0.001$) and Perceived Behavioral Control and Perceived Moral Obligation ($r = 0.386$, $p < 0.001$).

4.4.2 Regression

Table 11: Regression coefficient analysis

Model	Unstandardized B	Coefficients Std. Error	Standardized Coefficients Beta	t-value	Sig.
(Constant)	.044	.247		.180	.858
Attitude	.449	.079	.416	5.669	<.001
Subjective Norms	.108	.049	.119	2.190	.030
Perceived Behavioral Control	.412	.067	.417	6.162	<.001
Perceived Moral Obligation	-.004	.064	-.003	-.062	.951

This regression coefficient table shows that Attitude ($B = .449$, $Beta = .416$, $t\text{-value} = 5.669$) has a significance level of $p < .001$. Therefore, Attitude has a significant relationship with the Intention to Use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services. This is followed by Subjective Norms ($B = .108$, $Beta = .119$, $t\text{-value} = 2.190$), which also has a significance level of $p = .030$ indicating significant relationship with the Intention to Use BNPL services. Perceived Behavioral Control ($B = .412$, $Beta = .417$, $t\text{-value} = 6.162$) has a significance level of $p < .001$, representing a significant relationship with the dependent variable. Perceived Moral Obligation ($B = -.004$, $Beta = -.003$, $t\text{-value} = -.062$) has a significance level of $p = .951$, which is greater than 0.05. Thus, Perceived Moral Obligation has no significant relationship with the Intention to Use Buy Now Pay Later services.

4.4.3 Model Summary

Table 12 : Model Summary

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std Error of the estimate
1	.873	.762	.756	.51373

The model explained 76.2% of the variance in the intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services ($R^2=0.762$). This represents a high level of explanatory power, indicating that the combination of Attitude, Subjective Norms, and Perceived Behavioral Control is very effective at predicting whether a person intends to use "Buy Now Pay Later" services.

4.4.4 Hypothesis

Table 13 : Summary of hypothesis test

H1	Attitude positively influences intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Supported
H2	Subjective norms positively influence intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Supported
H3	Perceived behavioral control positively influences intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Supported
H4	Perceived moral obligation negatively influences intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Not supported

H1: Attitude has a significant effect on intention to use BNPL services.

Multiple regression analysis was used to examine how Attitude influences UUM students' intention to use BNPL services. The results showed that Attitude has a significant positive impact on the intention to use BNPL services ($\beta = 0.416$, $p\text{-value} < 0.001$). Therefore, H1 is supported.

H2: Subjective Norms have a significant effect on the intention to use BNPL services.

Multiple regression analysis was used to identify how Subjective Norms influence UUM students' intention to use BNPL services. The results showed that subjective norms had a significant positive impact on intention to use BNPL services ($\beta = 0.119$, $p\text{-value} < 0.030$). Therefore, H2 is supported.

H3: Perceived Behavioral Control has a significant effect on intention to use BNPL services.

Multiple regression analysis was used to analyze how Perceived Behavioral Control influences UUM students' intention to use BNPL services. The results showed that Perceived Behavioral Control has a significant positive impact on intention to use BNPL services ($\beta = 0.417$, $p\text{-value} = <0.001$). Therefore, H3 is supported.

H4: Perceived Moral Obligation has a negative effect on intention to use BNPL services.

Multiple regression analysis was used to analyze how Perceived Moral Obligation influences UUM students' intention to use BNPL services. The results showed that Perceived Moral Obligation does not have a significant impact on intention to use BNPL services ($\beta = -0.003$, $t\text{-value} = -0.062$, $p\text{-value} = 0.951$). Therefore, H4 is not supported.

5.0 DISCUSSION OF FINDINGS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSIONS

5.1 Summary of Findings

This study investigated the factors influencing UUM students' intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services. Overall, the findings indicate that BNPL services usage intention among students is influenced more by psychological and social factors than by demographic characteristics.

Reliability analysis confirmed that all constructs demonstrated acceptable to excellent internal consistency, indicating that the measurement instruments were reliable. Descriptive analysis revealed a moderate level of agreement for attitude, subjective norms, perceived behavioral control, perceived moral obligation, and intention to use BNPL services, while perceived moral obligation recorded a high level of agreement.

Inferential analysis showed no significant differences in BNPL services usage intention based on gender or age. Correlation Analysis indicated positive relationships among all study variables, with stronger associations observed between attitude, subjective norms, perceived behavioral control, perceived moral obligation, and intention to use BNPL services.

Multiple regression analysis revealed that attitude, subjective norms, perceived behavioral control had significant positive effects on students' intention to use BNPL services. However, perceived moral obligation did not have a significant influence on BNPL services intention. Overall, the findings show that students' intention to use BNPL services is primarily driven by their attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control rather than moral considerations.

5.2 Discussion

The findings of this study reveal that this attitude had a significant positive influence on UUM students' intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services. This suggests that students are more likely to use BNPL services when they perceive it as a convenient and beneficial payment method. This result supports the Theory of Planned Behavior, which posits that favourable attitudes increase behavioral intention. The finding is consistent with previous studies that reported attitude as a key determinant of BNPL services adoption among Generation Z consumers (Osman et al., 2024). In the context of UUM students, positive perceptions of BNPL services may stem from its flexibility and ease of managing short-term expenses. Therefore, BNPL service providers should emphasise positive usage experiences and clear benefits to strengthen favourable attitudes toward BNPL services.

The results indicate that subjective norms have a significant positive effect on students' intention to use BNPL services. This suggests that social influence from peers, friends, or family increases students' likelihood of adopting BNPL services. This finding aligns with the Theory of Planned Behavior, which highlights social pressure as an important determinant of intention. Similar results have been reported in prior studies, showing that peer acceptance and recommendations play a crucial role in BNPL usage among young consumers (Li et al., 2023). In a university setting, students may rely on peer experiences to evaluate the trustworthiness of BNPL services. Thus, BNPL service providers can utilize referral programmes and social media influence to enhance adoption among students.

The findings show that perceived behavioral control significantly and positively influences students' intention to use BNPL services. This indicates that students are more inclined to use BNPL services when they feel confident in managing repayments and understanding payment terms. This result supports the Theory of Planned Behavior, which asserts that greater perceived control enhances behavioral intention. The finding is consistent with earlier studies that identified ease of use and financial confidence as important factors in BNPL services usage intention (Osman et al., 2024). In the context of UUM students, clear installment structures may strengthen their sense of control despite limited financial resources. Therefore, BNPL service providers should ensure transparent terms and user-friendly platforms to enhance perceived behavioral control.

Contrary to expectations, perceived moral obligation was found to have no significant influence on students' intention to use BNPL services. This suggests that although students recognise moral or ethical responsibilities regarding debt, these considerations do not directly affect their BNPL services usage intention. This finding does not fully support the extended Theory of planned behavior that includes moral obligation as a predictor. One possible explanation is that students may perceive BNPL services as a low-risk or short-term financial tool rather than a serious form of debt. In the university context, practical and social considerations may outweigh moral concerns in financial decision-making. This indicates a need for greater emphasis on financial literacy to increase awareness of the long-term implications of BNPL services usage.

Overall, the discussion demonstrates that attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control play significant roles in shaping UUM students' intention to use BNPL services, supporting the core components of the Theory of Planned Behavior. However, perceived moral obligation did not significantly influence BNPL services intention, suggesting that moral considerations may be secondary to practical and social factors in students' financial decision-making. These findings provide valuable insights into BNPL services usage intention behavior among university students and serve as a foundation for developing effective marketing strategies and responsible financial practices.

5.3 Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, several recommendations are proposed for BNPL service providers and relevant stakeholders. Since attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control significantly influence UUM students' intention to use BNPL services, providers should emphasize convenience, flexibility, and clear value in their marketing communications. User-friendly interfaces, transparent repayment terms, and features such as payment reminders can help enhance students' confidence in managing BNPL service usage. In addition, peer influence strategies, including referral programmes and social media engagement, may be effective in encouraging adoption among university students. Financial literacy initiatives should also be promoted to raise awareness of responsible BNPL service usage.

For future research, studies may expand the sample to include students from other universities to improve generalisability. Future research could also adopt qualitative or mixed-method approaches to gain deeper insights into students' perceptions and decision-making processes related to BNPL services. Additionally, examining other psychological or financial factors, such as financial literacy, impulsive buying, or self-control, may further enhance understanding of BNPL services usage behavior.

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Appendices

Figure 1: Framework

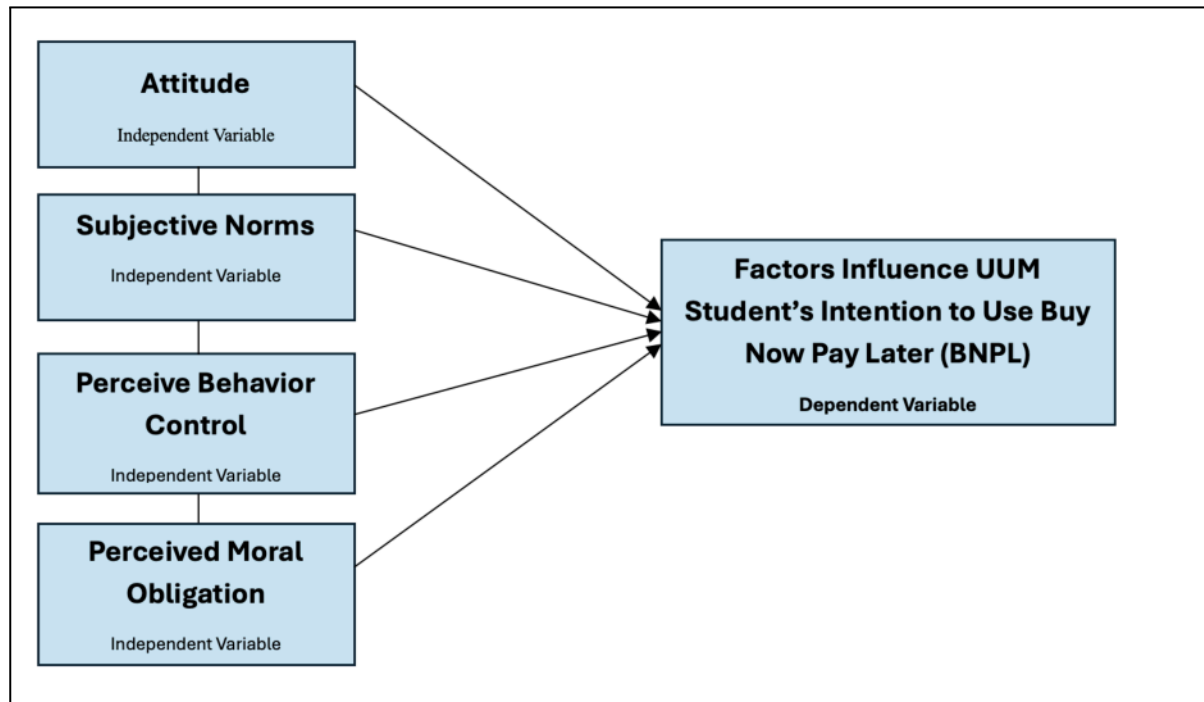


Table 1: Sample Item

Construct	No. of Items	Sample Item	Adapted Source
Attitude	4	"Using BNPL services is a good idea for payment."	(Lim et al., 2023)
Subjective Norms	4	"People who are important to me think I should use BNPL services."	(Osman et al., 2024)
Perceived Behavioral Control	4	"I am confident I can manage BNPL services payments responsibly."	(Hamid et al., 2023)
Perceived Moral Obligation	4	"I feel morally obliged to avoid unnecessary debt when using BNPL services."	(Zainuddin et al., 2023)
Intention to Use BNPL services	6	"I intend to use BNPL services in the next 6 months."	(Nguyen et al., 2022)

Table 2: Reliability coefficient value

Cronbach's Alpha	Reliability
> 0.9	Excellent
0.8 - 0.89	Good
0.7 - 0.79	Acceptable
0.6 - 0.69	Questionable
< 0.5	Unacceptable

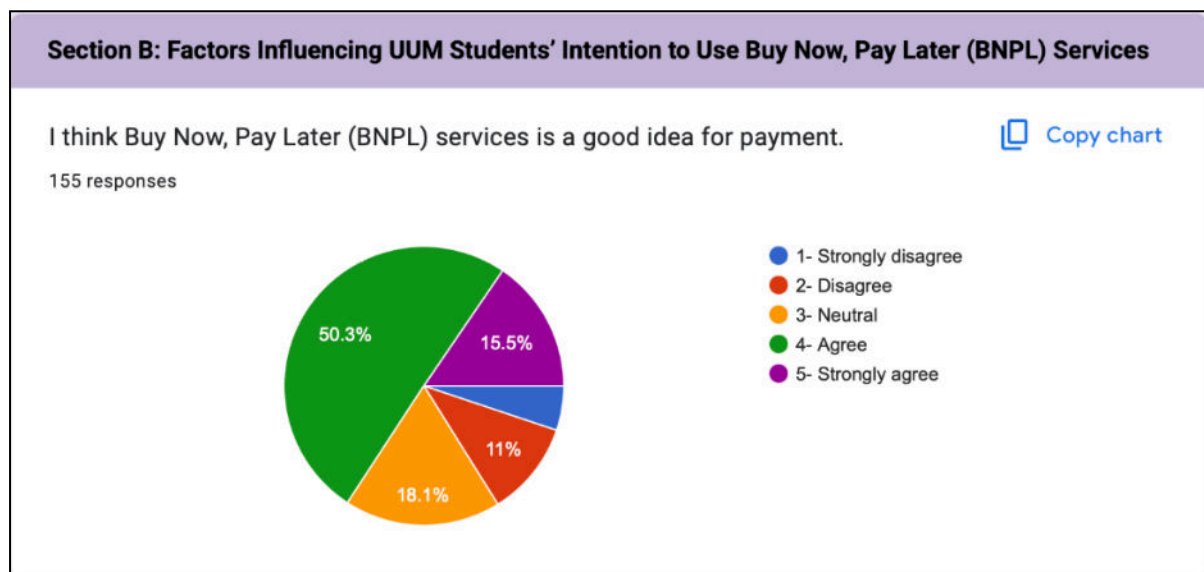
Table 3: Result of Reliability Test

Variable	Number of Items	Cronbach's Alpha	Result
Attitude	4	0.869	Good
Subjective Norms	4	0.907	Excellent
Perceived Behavioral Control	4	0.899	Good
Perceived Moral Obligation	4	0.726	Acceptable
Intention to Use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services	6	0.931	Excellent

Table 4: Respondents' profile for Questionnaire's Section A

		Frequency	Percentage %
Gender	Male	32	20.6
	Female	123	79.4
	Total	155	100
Ethnic	Malay	69	44.5
	Chinese	62	40
	India	17	11
	Siamese	6	3.9
	Others	1	0.6
	Total	155	100
Age	18 - 21	34	21.9
	22 - 25	117	75.5
	26 and above	4	2.6
	Total	155	100
Year	Year 1	15	9.7

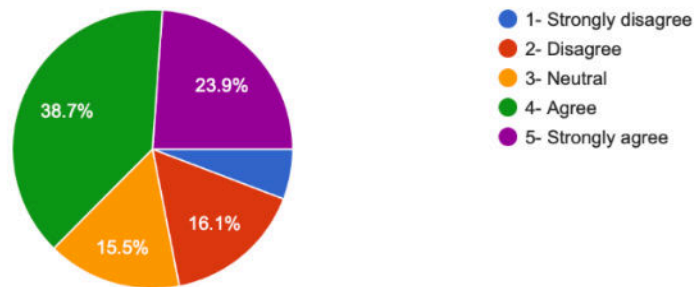
	Year 2	31	20
	Year 3	91	58.7
	Year 4	18	11.6
	Total	155	100
Monthly Allowance	RM0 - RM500	48	31
	RM501 - RM1000	42	27.1
	RM1001 - RM1500	34	21.9
	RM1501 - RM2000	14	9
	RM2001 and above	17	11
	Total	155	100
Shop online or not	Yes	135	87.1
	No	20	12.9
	Total	155	100



I think Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services is a wise choice.

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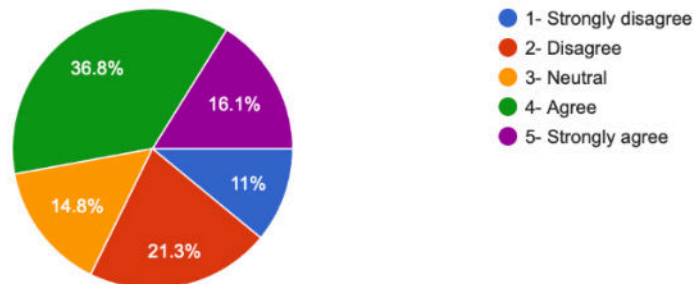
155 responses



I like the idea of Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services because it suitable for me.

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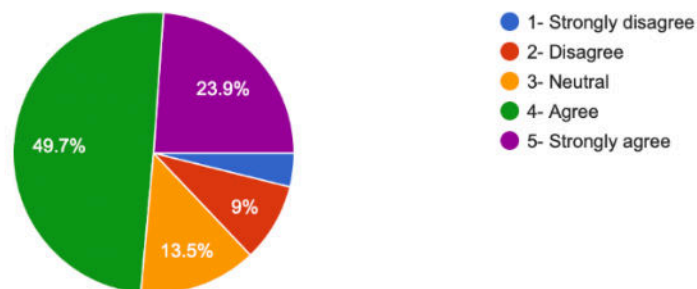
155 responses



I think Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services are easy to use.

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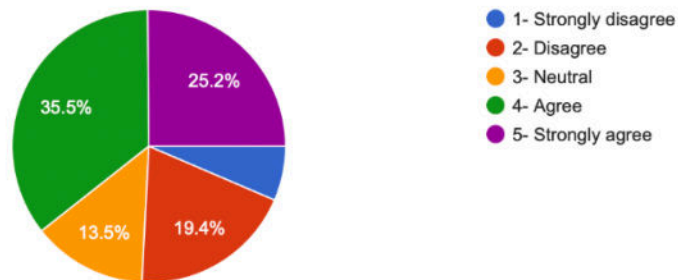
155 responses



My surroundings support the Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services.

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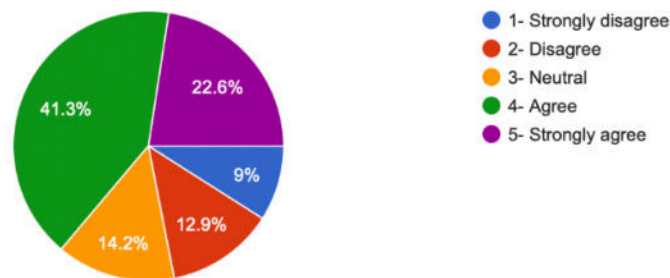
155 responses



Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services are widely used by people in my community.

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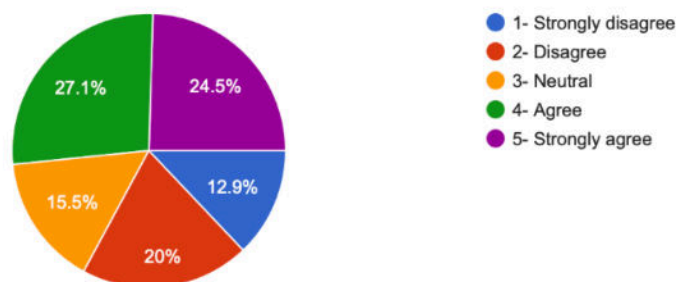
155 responses



People who are important to me expect me to use Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services.

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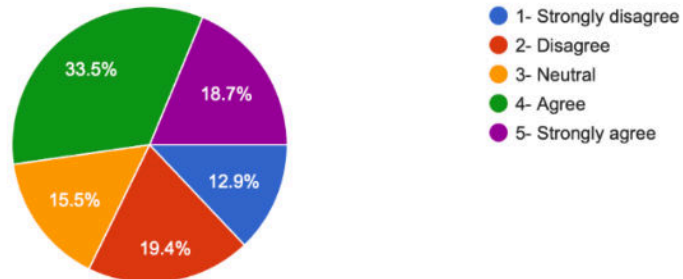
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People who are important to me are likely to recommend using Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services.

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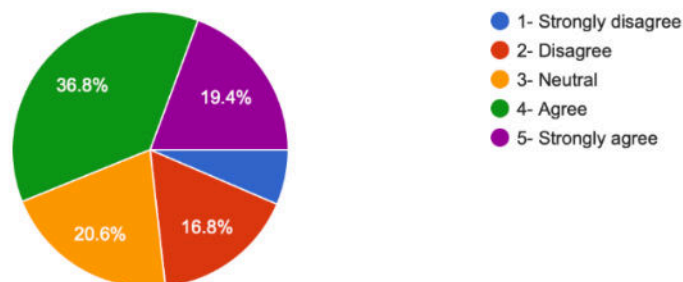
155 responses



I find it is easy to manage my Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) payments.

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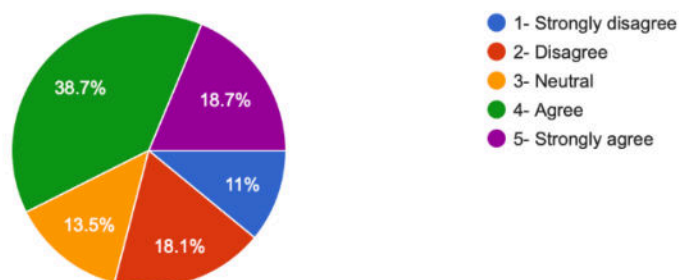
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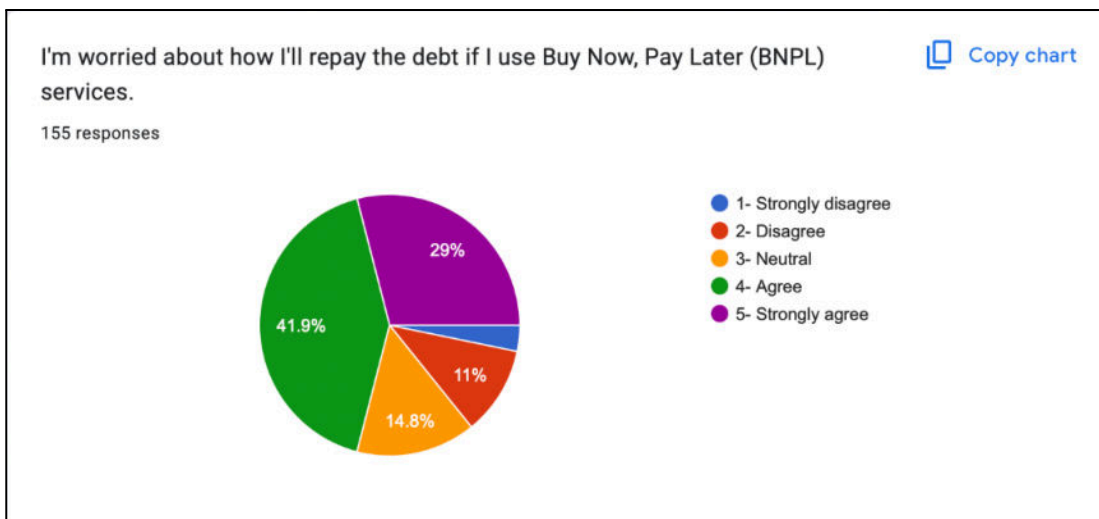
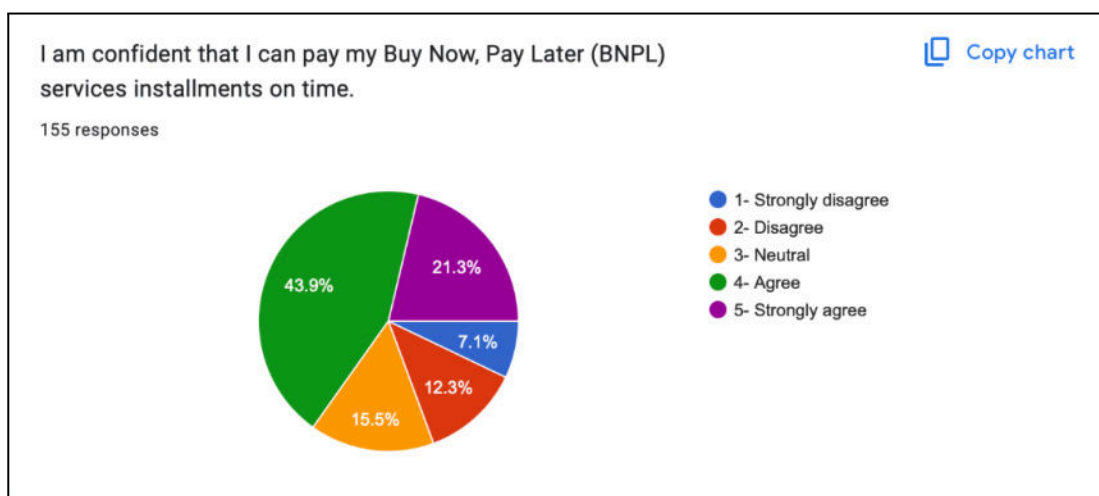
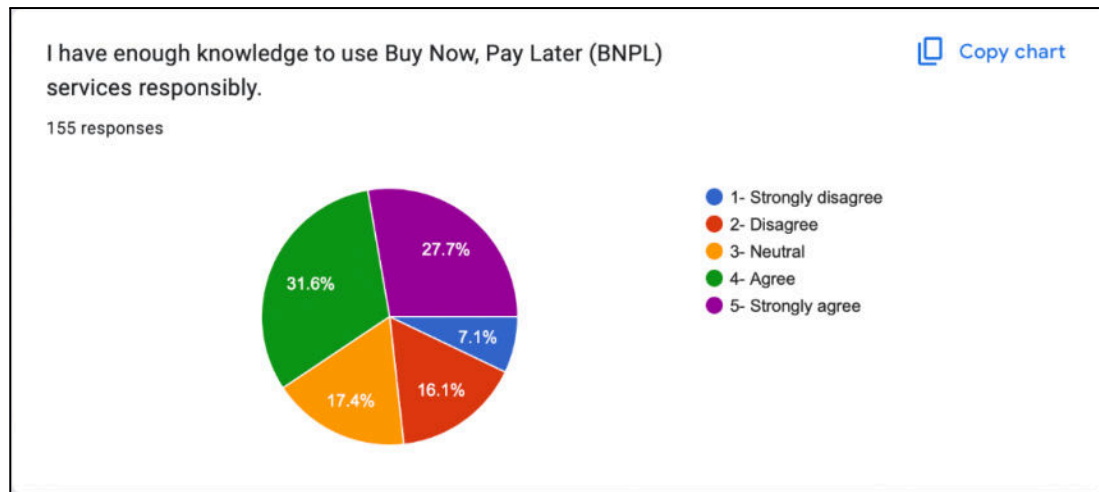


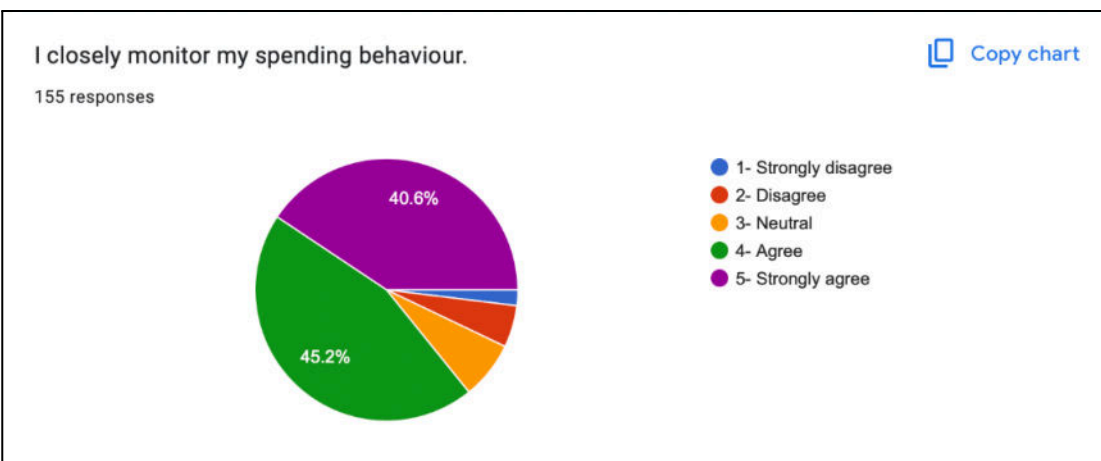
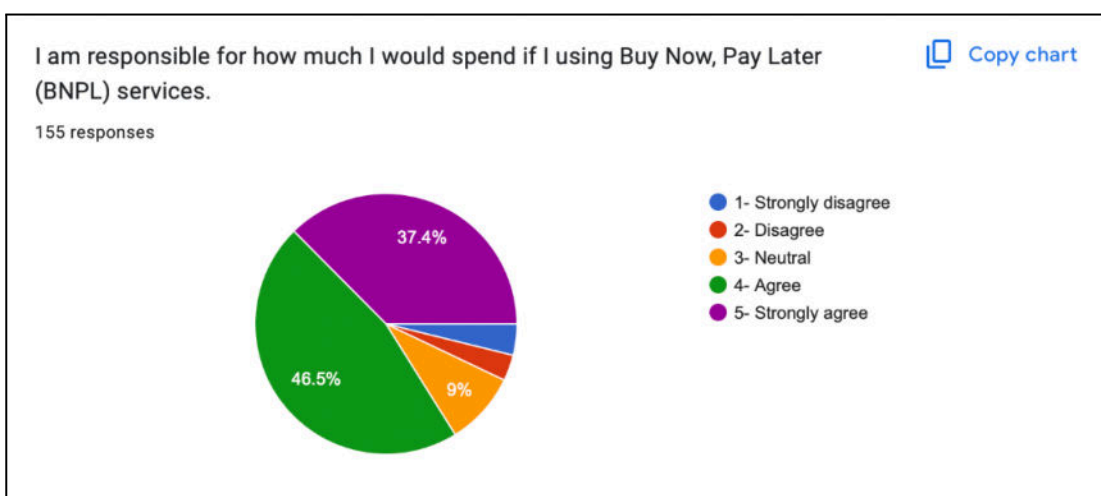
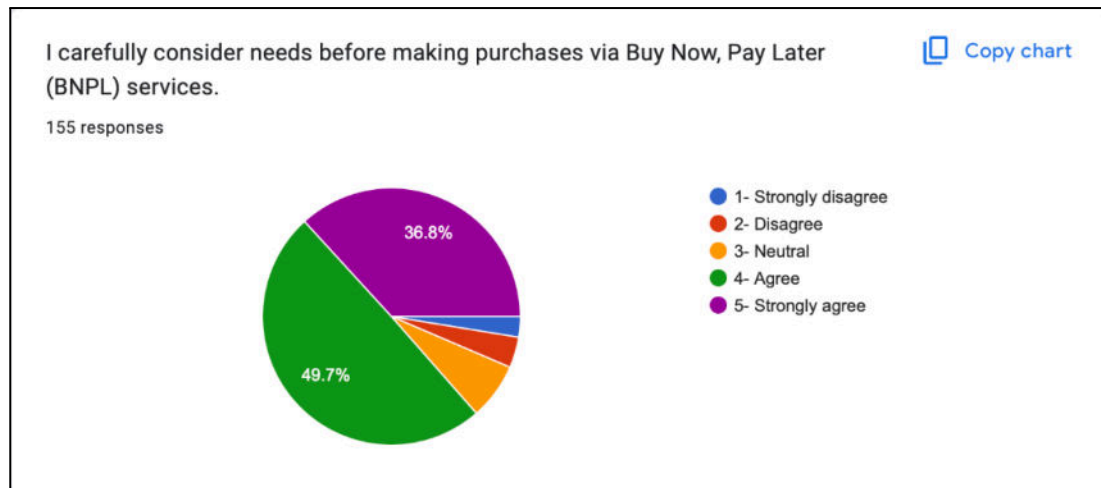
I think I can control my spending if I use Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services.

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155 responses





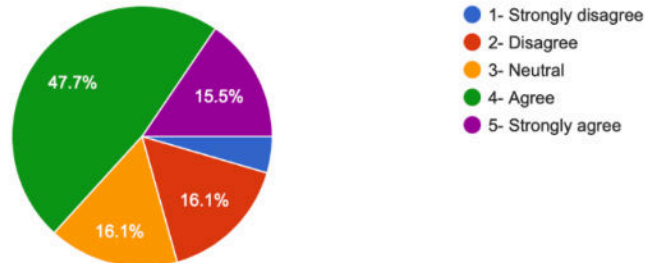


Section C: UUM Students' Intention to Use Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL)

I would use Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services for any purchase in the future.

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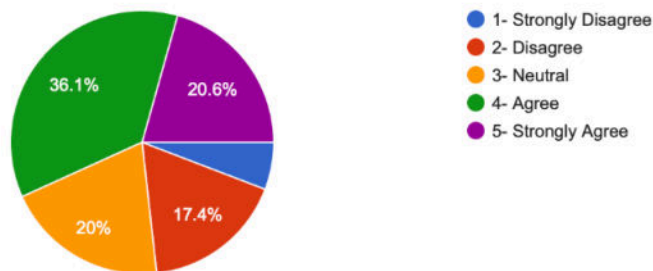
155 responses



Using Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services to handle my online shopping is something I would do.

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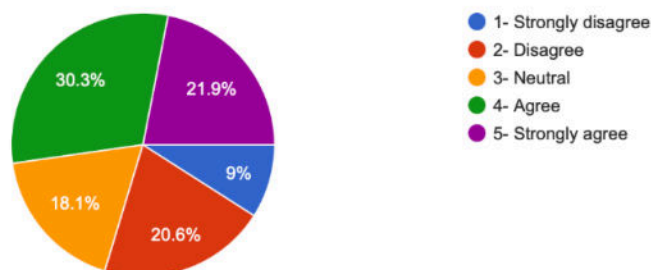
155 responses



I intend to use all the different kinds of Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services.

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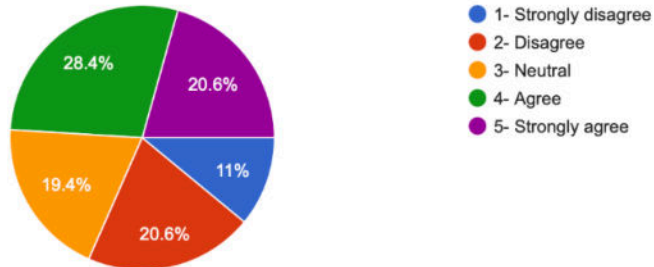
155 responses



I intend to recommend Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services to my family and friends.

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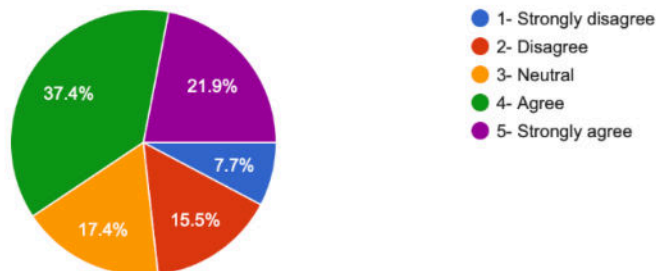
155 responses



I intend to try out the latest Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services.

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155 responses



I intend to use Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services more frequently in the future.

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155 responses

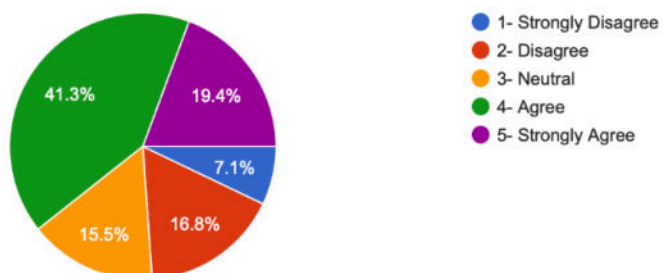


Table 5: Agreement level of mean measurement

Means range	Tendency level
High	3.68 - 5.00
Moderate	2.34 - 3.67
Low	1.00 - 2.33

Table 6: Descriptive analysis of each variables

Variables	Min	Max	Mean	Standard Deviation
IV Attitude	1	5	3.5645	0.9627
Subjective Norms	1	5	3.4129	1.1419
Perceived Behavioral Control	1	5	3.4968	1.0522
Perceived Moral Obligation	1	5	4.0645	0.7173
DV Intention to use Buy Now Pay Later	1	5	3.4398	1.0401

Table 7: Group Statistics

	Gender	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error Mean
Intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services	Male	32	3.1823	1.19464	.21118
	Female	123	3.5068	.99048	.8931

Table 8: Independent Samples Test

		F	Sig.	t	df	One-side d p	Two-side d p
Intention to use Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services	Equal variances assumed	.846	.359	-1.580	153	.054	.116
	Equal variances not assumed			-1.415	42.732	.082	.164

Table 9: Anova

	Sum of Squared	df	Mean Square	F	Sig
Between Groups	0.51	2	0.255	0.233	0.792
Within Groups	166.094	152	1.093		
Total	166.605	154			

Table 10: Correlation Analysis

		Attitude	Subjective Norms	Perceived Behavioral Control	Perceived Moral Obligation
Attitude	Pearson Correlation	1	.672	.802	.404
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	155	155	155	155
Subjective Norms	Pearson Correlation	.672	1	.601	.303
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	155	155	155	155
Perceived Behavioral Control	Pearson Correlation	.802	.601	1	.386
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	155	155	155	155
Perceived Moral Obligation	Pearson Correlation	.404	.303	.386	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	155	155	155	155

** . Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Table 11: Regression coefficient analysis

Model	Unstandardized B	Coefficients Std. Error	Standardized Coefficients Beta	t-value	Sig.
(Constant)	.044	.247		.180	.858
Attitude	.449	.079	.416	5.669	<.001
Subjective Norms	.108	.049	.119	2.190	.030
Perceived Behavioral Control	.412	.067	.417	6.162	<.001

Perceived Moral Obligation	-.004	.064	-.003	-.062	.951
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Table 12 : Model Summary

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std Error of the estimate
1	.873	.762	.756	.51373

Table 13 : Summary of hypothesis test

H1	Attitude positively influences intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Supported
H2	Subjective norms positively influence intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Supported
H3	Perceived behavioral control positively influences intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Supported
H4	Perceived moral obligation negatively influences intention to use Buy Now Pay Later services	Not supported